CASE STUDY | CORPORATE TREASURY ANALYSIS

A Comparative Corporate Treasury Analysis

Evaluating Cash Preservation vs. Capital Expenditure Strategies of Wipro and HCL Technologies

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Financial years FY2023 – FY2026 (years ended 31 March)
Consolidated statements · ₹ crore unless stated

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November 2026

Companion workbook: Wipro_vs_HCL_Treasury_Analysis.xlsx

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This report analyses public company filings and is not investment advice.

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1. Executive Summary

This project compares how Wipro and HCL Technologies (HCLTech) managed their cash and capital spending over four financial years, FY2023 to FY2026. It uses consolidated, audited figures from company filings in ₹ crore. Every figure in the companion workbook was re-checked against those filings, and several earlier figures were corrected (Section 6).

What the data shows:

- **Both companies are cash-rich and capital-light.** Wipro's cash and liquid investments (a comparable gross-cash measure) rose from ₹40,111 crore to ₹55,181 crore, or 38.9% of assets in FY2026. HCLTech's rose from ₹23,089 crore to ₹33,447 crore, or 28.8% of assets.
- **Neither company froze investment.** CapEx fell sharply in FY2024 at both firms (Wipro −29.1%, HCLTech −36.9%) and then recovered. In FY2026 CapEx was ₹1,560 crore at Wipro (1.68% of revenue) and ₹1,422 crore at HCLTech (1.09% of revenue).
- **Growth differs more than treasury policy does.** HCLTech's revenue grew 28.3% between FY2023 and FY2026 (about 8.7% a year). Wipro's grew 2.4% (about 0.8% a year).
- **Interest income is now measured directly, and it matters more to Wipro.** Wipro's interest income rose 68%, from ₹1,689 crore to ₹2,837 crore, and equalled 21.4% of net profit in FY2026. HCLTech's IFRS interest income was 9.3% of its IFRS profit. Wipro's earnings therefore lean about twice as heavily on treasury yield.
- **Shareholder returns differ in size and form.** HCLTech paid ₹57,936 crore in dividends over the four years (89.7% of cumulative profit). Wipro returned ₹36,116 crore through dividends and a buyback (73.8%), in lumpy steps: a ₹12,000 crore buyback in FY2024, ₹11,521 crore of dividends in FY2026, and a further ₹15,000 crore buyback announced in April 2026.

Overall judgement: neither company fits a simple label. Wipro follows a mixed capital allocation strategy on a liquidity-heavy balance sheet. HCLTech follows a balanced treasury strategy weighted towards distributions. HCLTech grew faster and used its resources somewhat more effectively on the evidence available, but the gap is not large, and Wipro's balance sheet gives it more room to act. Sections 12 to 15 set out the balanced conclusion.

2. Introduction to Corporate Treasury Management

Corporate treasury management is the work of making sure a company has the right amount of money, in the right form, at the right time. It covers cash and liquidity management, investing surplus funds, managing borrowings, handling currency and interest-rate risk, and deciding how much to pay back to shareholders.

Every treasury balances three goals. The first is safety: money must be available when needed. The second is return: idle cash should earn something. The third is flexibility: the company must be able to fund growth, acquisitions or downturns. These goals pull against each other. A large cash pile gives safety but earns low returns relative to the business. Heavy spending on facilities and technology can raise future earnings, but it uses up cash and cannot easily be reversed.

IT services companies such as Wipro and HCLTech are an interesting test. They do not need heavy factories or machinery; their main asset is people. Their CapEx is therefore small relative to revenue, and most growth capital goes into acquisitions and talent rather than buildings. This makes their treasury choices, especially how much cash to keep and how much to return to shareholders, central to value creation.

Two simple ratios frame this study. The cash-to-assets ratio shows how much of the balance sheet is held as cash and liquid investments. The CapEx-to-revenue ratio shows how much of each rupee of sales is reinvested in long-term assets. Read together over time, they indicate whether a company leans towards preserving cash or towards investing.

3. Objectives of the Study

1. To verify and correct the financial data in the existing workbook against official company filings for FY2023 to FY2026.
2. To measure cash preservation and capital spending at Wipro and HCLTech using consistent definitions and ratios.
3. To separate cash and cash equivalents from liquid investments, total other income from actual interest income, and interest recognised in the income statement from interest received in cash, so that conclusions are not distorted.
4. To judge, from the data, whether either company changed its treasury strategy over the four years.
5. To assess the effect of interest rates, industry demand, AI investment, acquisitions and shareholder returns on those choices.
6. To compare the two companies' treasury strategies and reach a balanced, evidence-based conclusion.

4. Company Profiles – Wipro and HCL Technologies

Wipro Limited

Wipro is a Bengaluru-based IT services and consulting company listed on the BSE, NSE and the New York Stock Exchange. It reports consolidated results under IFRS for its US filings and under Ind AS for Indian regulators; this study uses the IFRS statements. In FY2026 it reported revenue of ₹92,624 crore and net profit of ₹13,266 crore. IT services revenue was US$10.5 billion, 1.6% lower in constant currency. It ended the year with 242,156 employees. Management describes a pivot to an AI-first model, including a new AI Native Business & Platforms unit.

Wipro's capital allocation in the period included a ₹12,000 crore buyback completed in FY2024, acquisitions (notably Rizing in FY2023 and Harman DTS in FY2026, for a cash consideration of ₹3,404 crore), regular dividends (₹11 per share paid in FY2026) and, after year-end, a Board-approved ₹15,000 crore buyback at ₹250 per share, subject to shareholder approval.

HCL Technologies

HCLTech is a Noida-based global technology company with services (IT and business services, and engineering and R&D) and a software division, HCLSoftware. It reports under Ind AS for Indian filings and publishes IFRS statements in US dollars. In FY2026 it reported revenue of ₹130,144 crore (US$14.7 billion, up 3.9% in constant currency) and profit for the year of ₹16,652 crore. It had 227,181 people at year-end. Annualised Advanced AI revenue passed US$620 million in Q4 FY2026, and HCLSoftware's annual recurring revenue stood at US$1.05 billion.

HCLTech's capital allocation is marked by steady, high dividends (₹60 per share declared for FY2026, 97.6% of EPS), selective acquisitions, almost no borrowings, and a stated company-level return on invested capital of 40.3% in FY2026.

5. Research Methodology

The study is a comparative, secondary-data case study. Figures come from audited consolidated financial statements, company results releases and annual-report filings (listed in Section 17 and in the "Sources & References" sheet of the workbook). No figure was estimated or converted between currencies. Where a figure could not be found in the sources reviewed, it is marked "Not available". Every figure carries a verification status in the workbook's Verification Log: Verified, Corrected, Not separately disclosed, Not available, or Requires further verification.

Definitions used

Item	Definition used in this study
Cash and cash equivalents	Balance-sheet line only. It excludes bank deposits and investments.
Cash and liquid investments (gross cash)	Comparable measure. Wipro: cash and cash equivalents + current investments + non-current deposits. HCLTech: the company's own "Gross Cash" (cash, fixed deposits and investment securities), shown as a total so that cash is not counted twice. The two definitions are close but not identical.
Other income	Wipro: IFRS "Finance and other income" (interest, dividends, investment gains). HCLTech: statutory "Other income". Both contain more than interest, so they are comparison indicators only, and they are already included in net profit.
Interest income	The interest line in the notes to the financial statements, recognised on an accrual basis. Wipro: all four years (note to its IFRS statements). HCLTech: available only in its IFRS US$ statements (FY2024 to FY2026); the ₹ note is not available.
Interest received	Cash interest received, from the cash-flow statement. Wipro: all four years. HCLTech: IFRS US$ only (FY2024 to FY2026).
CapEx	Cash purchase of property, plant and equipment. HCLTech reports PP&E and intangibles in one cash-flow line. Wipro reports PP&E only.
Net profit	Profit for the year including non-controlling interest, for both companies (statutory basis).
Basis	Consolidated; years ended 31 March; ₹ crore. Wipro under IFRS (₹ million ÷ 10); HCLTech under Ind AS, plus an IFRS US$ supplement for interest income.

Ratios

Cash-to-assets = cash and cash equivalents ÷ total assets. Gross cash-to-assets = comparable gross cash ÷ total assets. CapEx-to-revenue = CapEx ÷ revenue. Other income-to-net profit = other income ÷ net profit. Interest income-to-net profit = interest income ÷ net profit (for HCLTech, both terms from its IFRS statements). Payout = (dividends + buybacks) ÷ net profit. Growth rates are year on year. All ratios are live formulas in the workbook.

The other income and interest income ratios are indicators of how large treasury-type income is relative to profit. Income is earned before tax and profit is after tax, so the ratios are indicative, not a measure of how much profit "comes from" interest.

6. Financial Data Overview

Tables 1 to 3 show the verified data used in later sections. Table 4 summarises the main corrections made to the original workbook.

Table 1 – Wipro: verified financial data (₹ crore, IFRS)

Wipro	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026
Revenue	90,488	89,760	89,088	92,624
Net profit	11,367	11,112	13,218	13,266

Wipro	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026
Other income (finance & other income)	1,819	2,390	3,820	3,649
Interest income (accrual)	1,689	1,948	2,721	2,837
Interest received (cash)	1,411	2,011	2,621	2,888
Cash and cash equivalents	9,188	9,695	12,197	10,556
Current investments	30,923	31,117	41,147	43,768
Non-current deposits	0	0	781	857
Gross cash (comparable)	40,111	40,812	54,126	55,181
Total assets	117,582	115,246	128,652	141,926
CapEx	1,483	1,051	1,474	1,560
Borrowings	15,009	14,147	16,182	16,787
Dividends paid	3,281	522	6,275	11,521
Share buyback (cash outflow)	0	14,517	0	0
Business acquisitions (cash)	4,557	529	96	2,603

Sources: Wipro Q4 FY2024 and Q4 FY2026 consolidated IFRS statements (statement of income p.2, financial position p.1, cash flows p.6; notes 8, 10, 13, 23/24). Figures are ₹ million ÷ 10. Non-current deposits for FY2023–24 are disclosed as below ₹1 million and entered as zero.

Table 2 – HCLTech: verified financial data (₹ crore, Ind AS)

HCLTech	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026
Revenue	101,456	109,913	117,055	130,144
Net profit	14,845	15,710	17,399	16,652
Other income (statutory)	1,358	1,495	2,485	1,530
Interest income (Ind AS, ₹)	Not available	Not available	Not available	Not available
Cash and cash equivalents	9,065	9,456	8,245	8,265
Gross cash (company definition)	23,089	28,273	30,943	33,447
Total assets	93,411	99,777	105,544	116,258
CapEx (PP&E + intangibles)	1,661	1,048	1,108	1,422
Borrowings	Not available	Not available	2,291	159
Dividends paid	12,995	14,073	16,250	14,618
Business acquisitions (payments)	738	2,048	2,032	160

Sources: HCLTech Q4 and Annual FY2026 investor release (FY2025–26 balance sheet, cash-flow summary and Gross Cash table); Directors' Reports and NSE-filed audited results (revenue and other income). FY2023–24 balance-sheet, CapEx, Gross Cash and dividend figures are from the HCLTech Q4 and Annual FY2024 investor release (Balance Sheet and Cash Flow Summary, and Gross Cash and Net Cash table). FY2026 net profit is the statutory figure (owners ₹16,642 crore plus non-controlling interest ₹10 crore); the company's headline ₹17,361 crore excludes a one-time ₹719 crore labour-code cost.

Table 3 – HCLTech: IFRS supplement (US$ million)

HCLTech (IFRS, US$ mn)	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026
Revenue	12,586	13,270	13,840	14,664
Profit for the year	Not available	1,897	2,042	1,878
Interest income (note 3.15)	Not available	153	185	174
of which bank and other deposits	Not available	118	139	132
Interest received (cash flow)	Not available	126	156	161
Gross cash (company definition)	Not available	3,390*	3,619	3,527

*Source: HCLTech consolidated IFRS financial statements (US$), years ended 31 March 2025 and 2026 and 2024. HCLTech reports these in US dollars; they are not converted into ₹. *FY2024 gross cash is derived by adding the reported cash, bank-balance, deposit and investment lines of the IFRS balance sheet.*

Table 4 – Principal corrections to the original workbook (₹ crore)

Item	Year	Original	Verified	What was wrong	Status
HCL other income	FY2023	1,076	1,358	Standalone figure for another year, not consolidated FY2023	Corrected
HCL other income	FY2024	1,234	1,495	Standalone figure for another year	Corrected
HCL cash	FY2025	21,289	8,245	Included other bank balances; cash & equivalents is 8,245	Corrected
HCL cash	FY2026	23,425	8,265	Same issue (cash plus other bank balances)	Corrected
HCL total assets	FY2026	115,112	116,258	Does not match the investor release	Corrected
HCL CapEx	FY2025	1,684	1,108	Does not match the cash-flow statement	Corrected
HCL net profit	FY2026	16,642	16,652	Original mixed owners' profit with total profit	Corrected
Wipro total assets	FY2025	138,420	128,652	Does not match the IFRS balance sheet	Corrected
Wipro cash	FY2025	11,512	12,197	Does not match the IFRS balance sheet	Corrected
Wipro CapEx	FY2024	1,740	1,051	Does not match the cash-flow statement	Corrected
Wipro other income	FY2025	2,641	3,820	Not traceable to IFRS finance and other income	Corrected

Of the 48 original data points compared, 27 were corrected, 18 were verified as correct, and 3 remain flagged "Requires further verification": HCLTech FY2025 other income, and HCLTech FY2023–24 net profit, where the owners-only and total-profit bases differ slightly and the statutory total is used. Revenue figures matched. In total, the Verification Log records a status for 112 figures: 73 Verified, 27 Corrected, 9 Not available and 3 Requires further verification. The full list is in the Verification Log sheet. The original Wipro EPS series mixes pre- and post-bonus share counts and was not used.

Interest income recognised versus interest received

Interest income in the income statement is recognised on an accrual basis. It includes interest that has been earned but not yet collected and the amortisation of premiums and discounts. Interest received in the cash-flow statement is the cash actually collected in the year. The two differ by the change in interest receivable and by timing.

For Wipro the figures are: FY2023 accrual ₹1,689 crore against cash ₹1,411 crore; FY2024 ₹1,948 crore against ₹2,011 crore; FY2025 ₹2,721 crore against ₹2,621 crore; FY2026 ₹2,837 crore against ₹2,888 crore. In FY2026 cash collected exceeded the accrual by about ₹51 crore, which reflects collection of previously accrued interest. For HCLTech, cash interest is available only in its IFRS statements: US$126 million, US$156 million and US$161 million for FY2024 to FY2026, against accrual interest income of US$153 million, US$185 million and US$174 million.

7. Wipro Financial Analysis

Table 5 – Wipro ratios

Wipro ratios	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026
Cash-to-assets	7.8%	8.4%	9.5%	7.4%
Cash + current investments-to-assets (original measure)	34.1%	35.4%	41.5%	38.3%
Gross cash-to-assets (comparable)	34.1%	35.4%	42.1%	38.9%
CapEx-to-revenue	1.64%	1.17%	1.65%	1.68%
Other income-to-net profit	16.0%	21.5%	28.9%	27.5%
Interest income-to-net profit	14.9%	17.5%	20.6%	21.4%
Revenue growth	n/a	-0.8%	-0.7%	4.0%

Wipro ratios	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026
Net profit growth	n/a	-2.2%	19.0%	0.4%
Cash balance growth	n/a	5.5%	25.8%	-13.5%
Gross cash growth	n/a	1.7%	32.6%	1.9%
CapEx growth	n/a	-29.1%	40.2%	5.9%
Shareholder payout (dividends + buyback ÷ profit)	28.9%	135.3%	47.5%	86.8%

The original-measure row counts cash plus current investments only; the comparable row also adds non-current deposits (₹781 crore in FY2025 and ₹857 crore in FY2026).

Revenue and profit

Wipro's revenue was almost flat over the period: down 0.8% in FY2024 and 0.7% in FY2025, then up 4.0% in FY2026. Net profit fell 2.2% in FY2024 (₹11,112 crore), rose 19.0% in FY2025 to ₹13,218 crore and held there in FY2026 (₹13,266 crore). Profit therefore grew faster than revenue. Part of this came from better margins (IT services operating margin was 17.2% in FY2026, up 0.2 points) and part from higher treasury income.

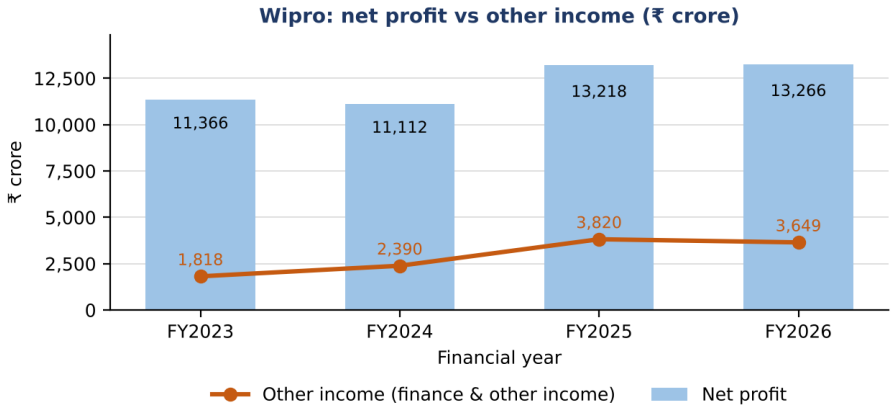


Figure 1 – Wipro: net profit (columns) and other income (line), ₹ crore. Other income is a component of profit, not an addition to it, so the two are not stacked. Both series use one axis so their relative size is not distorted.

Other income and interest income

Other income roughly doubled from ₹1,819 crore to ₹3,649 crore, and its ratio to net profit rose from 16.0% to 27.5%, peaking at 28.9% in FY2025. Other income is an accounting subtotal: it contains interest, dividends and investment gains. The actual interest income in the notes grew from ₹1,689 crore to ₹2,837 crore (+68%) and rose from 14.9% to 21.4% of net profit. About 78% of FY2026 other income was interest.

Between FY2025 and FY2026 other income fell 4.5% while interest income rose 4.3%, so the dip came from non-interest components. Over the whole period interest income rose ₹1,148 crore against a ₹1,899 crore rise in net profit. Because interest is pre-tax and profit is post-tax, this comparison is indicative only, but it shows that Wipro's profit growth leaned noticeably on treasury income.

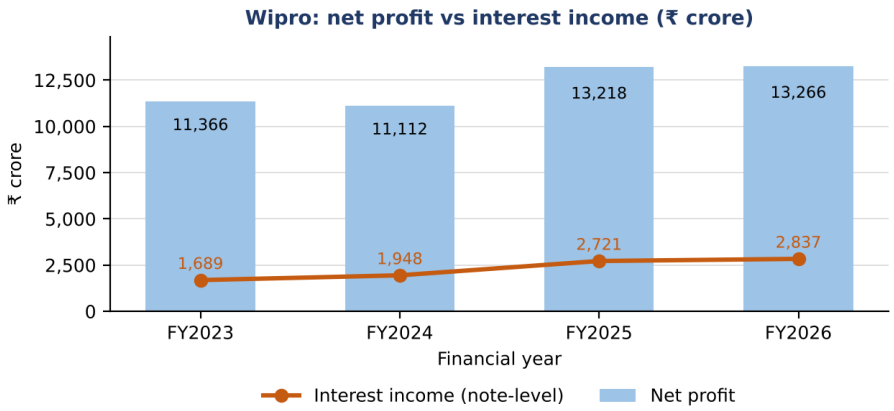


Figure 2 – Wipro: net profit (columns) and actual interest income (line), ₹ crore. Interest income is the note-level accrual figure, which is narrower than total other income.

Cash and liquidity

Cash and cash equivalents moved from ₹9,188 crore to ₹10,556 crore, with a peak of ₹12,197 crore in FY2025, so the cash-to-assets ratio stayed in a narrow band (7.8%, 8.4%, 9.5%, 7.4%). The picture changes when liquid investments are included. Comparable gross cash grew from ₹40,111 crore to ₹55,181 crore (+37.6%), or from 34.1% to 38.9% of assets, after peaking at 42.1% in FY2025. Wipro's treasury is mostly held in investments rather than bank cash. The FY2026 fall in cash (−13.5%) coincided with a ₹2,621 crore rise in current investments, so it reflects treasury allocation rather than a liquidity squeeze.

Wipro also carries borrowings (₹16,787 crore at March 2026, including US$750 million of 1.50% notes due June 2026). Net cash, meaning gross cash less borrowings, was ₹38,394 crore in FY2026, up from ₹25,102 crore in FY2023. Holding cash and low-coupon debt together gives positive carry when deposits earn about 5%.

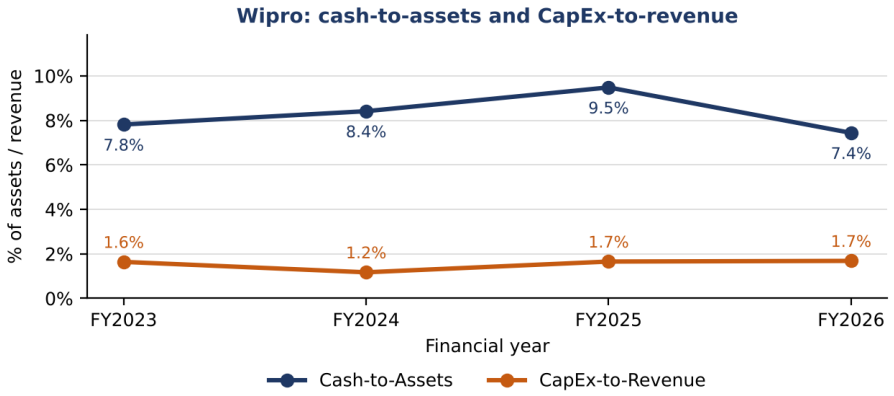


Figure 3 – Wipro: cash-to-assets and CapEx-to-revenue (percent).

Capital expenditure, acquisitions and shareholder returns

Wipro's CapEx dropped 29.1% in FY2024 to ₹1,051 crore, then rose 40.2% in FY2025 and 5.9% in FY2026 to ₹1,560 crore. CapEx stayed at about 1.2% to 1.7% of revenue after the FY2024 low. This pattern is not a freeze: it is a dip followed by a rebuild, with FY2026 CapEx 5.2% above FY2023.

Acquisitions were a larger call on cash than CapEx in some years: ₹4,557 crore in FY2023, ₹529 crore in FY2024, ₹96 crore in FY2025 and ₹2,603 crore in FY2026 (including Harman DTS). Goodwill rose by ₹6,239 crore in FY2026, partly through acquisitions and partly through currency translation. Shareholder

returns were lumpy: dividends of ₹3,281 crore, ₹522 crore, ₹6,275 crore and ₹11,521 crore, and a FY2024 buyback with a cash outflow of ₹14,517 crore including tax.

8. HCL Technologies Financial Analysis

Table 6 – HCLTech ratios

HCLTech ratios	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026
Cash-to-assets	9.7%	9.5%	7.8%	7.1%
Gross cash-to-assets (company definition)	24.7%	28.3%	29.3%	28.8%
CapEx-to-revenue	1.64%	0.95%	0.95%	1.09%
Other income-to-net profit	9.1%	9.5%	14.3%	9.2%
Interest income-to-net profit (IFRS, US$ basis)	n/a	8.1%	9.1%	9.3%
Revenue growth	n/a	8.3%	6.5%	11.2%
Net profit growth	n/a	5.8%	10.8%	-4.3%
Cash balance growth	n/a	4.3%	-12.8%	0.2%
Gross cash growth	n/a	22.5%	9.4%	8.1%
CapEx growth	n/a	-36.9%	5.7%	28.3%
Shareholder payout (dividends ÷ profit)	87.5%	89.6%	93.4%	87.8%

HCLTech's ₹ note-level interest income is not available, so the interest ratio uses its IFRS statements in US dollars, with both numerator and denominator taken from the same IFRS statements. FY2023 IFRS interest income was not extracted.

Revenue and profit

HCLTech grew in every year: 8.3% in FY2024, 6.5% in FY2025 and 11.2% in FY2026, taking revenue to ₹130,144 crore. Some of the FY2026 rupee growth came from a weaker rupee: constant-currency growth was 3.9%. Net profit rose to ₹17,399 crore in FY2025, then fell 4.3% to ₹16,652 crore in FY2026. The company reported that this included a one-time labour-code impact of ₹719 crore at net-income level and restructuring costs; excluding the labour-code item, net income was ₹17,361 crore, down 0.2%.

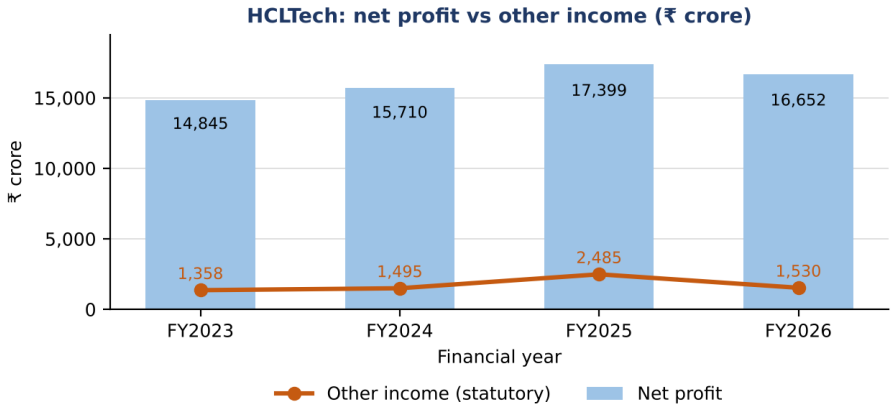


Figure 4 – HCLTech: net profit (columns) and statutory other income (line), ₹ crore. Other income is already part of profit and is not stacked on it.

Other income was ₹1,358 crore in FY2023 and ₹1,530 crore in FY2026, between 9.1% and 9.2% of net profit in those two years. FY2025 stands out at ₹2,485 crore (14.3% of net profit). HCLTech's IFRS statements record a divestment gain of about US$69 million in FY2025, which coincides with the spike; the Ind AS note should be checked before drawing a firm conclusion. Compared with Wipro, HCLTech's profit depends far less on other income.

Interest income

HCLTech's IFRS interest income was US$153 million, US$185 million and US$174 million in FY2024 to FY2026, of which US$118 million, US$139 million and US$132 million came from bank and other deposits. It equalled 8.1%, 9.1% and 9.3% of IFRS profit, less than half of Wipro's share. Cash interest received was US$126 million, US$156 million and US$161 million. Interest as a share of average gross cash was 5.3% in FY2025 and 4.9% in FY2026 (Wipro: 5.7% and 5.2%).

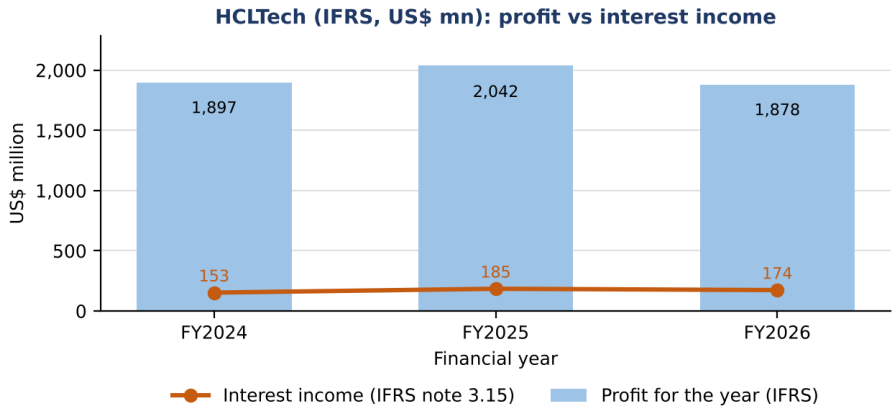


Figure 5 – HCLTech (IFRS, US$ million): profit for the year (columns) and interest income (line), FY2024 to FY2026. US$ is used because the ₹ note-level figure is not available; FY2023 is not available.

Cash and liquidity

Cash and cash equivalents were ₹9,065 crore in FY2023 and ₹8,265 crore in FY2026, so the cash-to-assets ratio fell from 9.7% to 7.1%. This is not a weaker treasury. The company's gross cash (cash, fixed deposits and investment securities) rose from ₹23,089 crore to ₹33,447 crore (+44.9%), or from 24.7% to 28.8% of assets. In FY2026 it comprised cash of ₹8,265 crore, fixed deposits of ₹18,222 crore and investment securities of ₹6,960 crore. Borrowings were only ₹159 crore at March 2026, down from ₹2,291 crore a year earlier, giving net cash of ₹33,288 crore.

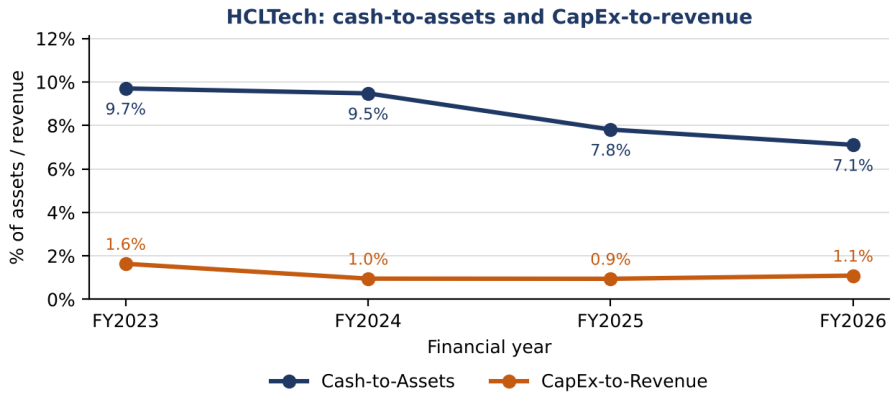


Figure 6 – HCLTech: cash-to-assets and CapEx-to-revenue (percent).

Capital expenditure, acquisitions and shareholder returns

CapEx (PP&E and intangibles) went from ₹1,661 crore in FY2023 to ₹1,048 crore in FY2024 (−36.9%), then ₹1,108 crore and ₹1,422 crore. The ratio to revenue fell from 1.64% to 1.09%, a fall of 54 basis points. About two-thirds of that fall comes from the 28.3% growth in revenue and the rest from CapEx being lower than in FY2023. It would be wrong to read the ratio alone as reduced investment: CapEx has risen 35.7% since the FY2024 low and was up 28.3% in FY2026.

After year-end HCLTech announced larger plans. In July 2026 it said it plans to invest up to ₹3,500 crore in AI data centres through new subsidiaries, and it then announced a first AI data centre in Bhubaneswar with Sarvam and the Odisha government, with a planned capital outlay of ₹14,257 crore including state financial assistance. These announcements post-date FY2026 and their spending is not yet in the data.

Acquisition payments were ₹738 crore, ₹2,048 crore, ₹2,032 crore and ₹160 crore in FY2023 to FY2026. Dividends paid were ₹12,995 crore, ₹14,073 crore, ₹16,250 crore and ₹14,618 crore. FY2026 dividends of ₹14,618 crore equal 87.8% of profit on a paid basis; the ₹60 per share declared for FY2026 equals 97.6% of EPS, because the declared and paid bases fall in different periods.

9. Comparative Financial Analysis

Table 7 – Side-by-side comparison, FY2023 and FY2026

Indicator	Wipro FY23	Wipro FY26	HCL FY23	HCL FY26
Revenue (₹ cr)	90,488	92,624	101,456	130,144
Net profit (₹ cr)	11,367	13,266	14,845	16,652
Cash & equivalents (₹ cr)	9,188	10,556	9,065	8,265
Gross cash (₹ cr)	40,111	55,181	23,089	33,447
Total assets (₹ cr)	117,582	141,926	93,411	116,258
Cash-to-assets	7.8%	7.4%	9.7%	7.1%
Gross cash-to-assets	34.1%	38.9%	24.7%	28.8%
CapEx (₹ cr)	1,483	1,560	1,661	1,422
CapEx-to-revenue	1.64%	1.68%	1.64%	1.09%
Other income-to-net profit	16.0%	27.5%	9.1%	9.2%
Interest income-to-net profit	14.9%	21.4%	n/a	9.3% (IFRS)
Cumulative payout FY23–26		73.8%		89.7%

HCLTech FY2023 interest income is not available. HCLTech's interest ratio is on an IFRS US$ basis. Cumulative payout = dividends plus buybacks FY2023–26 ÷ cumulative net profit.

Cash and liquid reserves

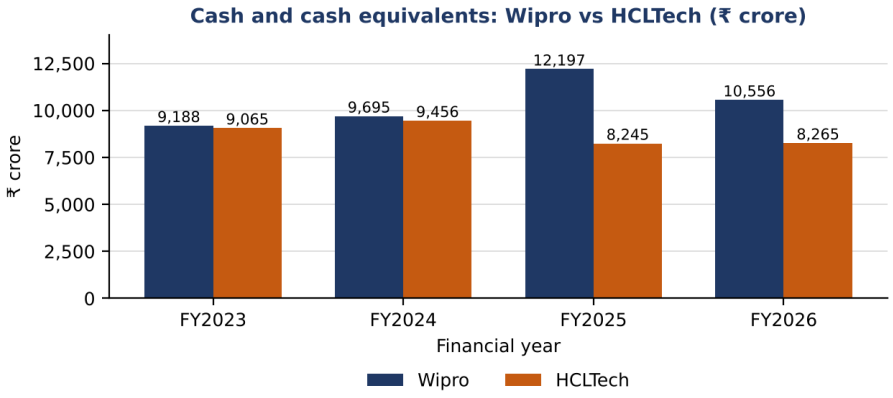


Figure 7 – Cash and cash equivalents, ₹ crore. Bank cash alone understates both treasuries.

Which company held more cash? In absolute bank cash Wipro held more (₹10,556 crore against ₹8,265 crore in FY2026), and its cash-to-assets ratio was slightly higher (7.4% against 7.1%). HCLTech's ratio was higher in FY2023 and FY2024. Over the full period Wipro's cash rose 14.9% while HCLTech's fell 8.8%.

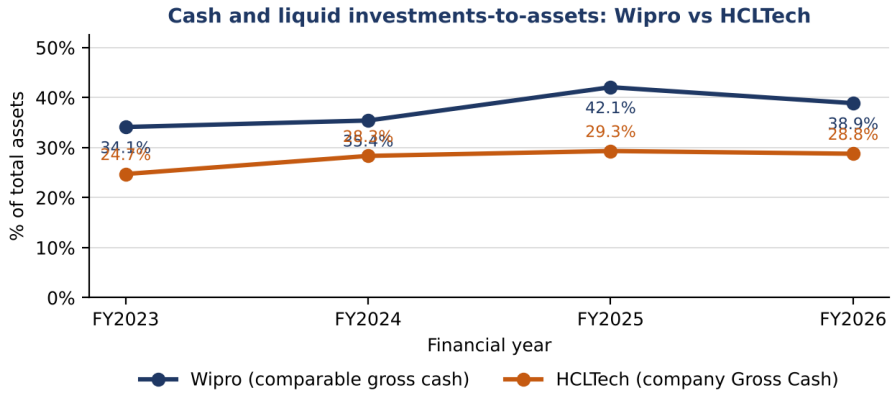


Figure 8 – Cash and liquid investments as a share of total assets. Wipro: cash + current investments + non-current deposits. HCLTech: company-defined Gross Cash. The definitions are close but not identical.

Which company increased its liquid reserves? Both. Wipro's comparable gross cash rose 37.6% and HCLTech's 44.9% between FY2023 and FY2026, so HCLTech's reserves grew faster from a lower base. Wipro held the larger share of assets throughout (38.9% against 28.8% in FY2026). Both ratios peaked in FY2025 (42.1% and 29.3%) and eased in FY2026 because total assets grew by about 10% at each company, faster than reserves. Because the definitions are not identical, gaps of one or two percentage points should not be over-read.

Capital expenditure

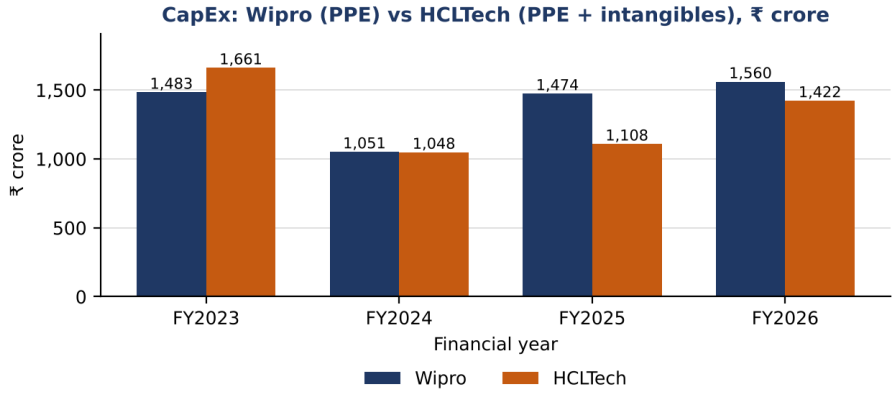


Figure 9 – CapEx, ₹ crore. Wipro: PP&E only. HCLTech: PP&E and intangibles. Both firms cut spending in FY2024 and then rebuilt it.

Wipro's four-year CapEx totalled ₹5,568 crore and HCLTech's ₹5,239 crore, although HCLTech's revenue is much larger. HCLTech's FY2026 CapEx (₹1,422 crore) is still below its FY2023 level (₹1,661 crore), while Wipro's (₹1,560 crore) is above its FY2023 level. Because HCLTech's figure includes intangibles and Wipro's does not, HCLTech's lower intensity is conservative rather than an artefact of definitions.

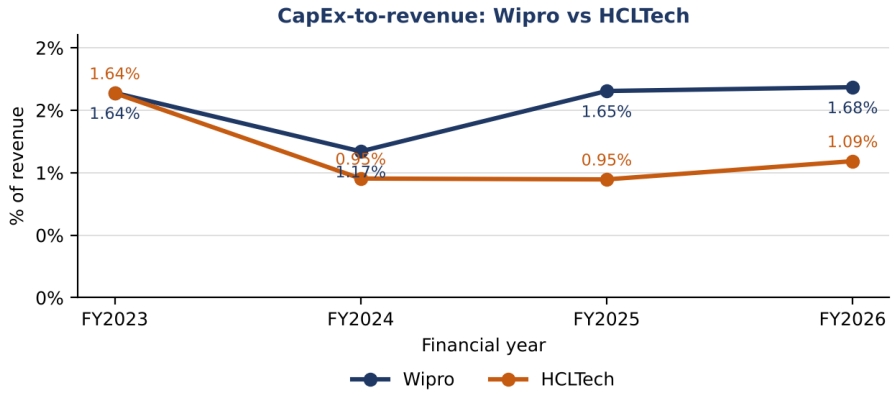


Figure 10 – CapEx-to-revenue. Wipro reinvested a higher share of revenue in every year from FY2024.

Which company invested a larger share of revenue? Wipro, in every year from FY2024: 1.68% against 1.09% in FY2026. The two were equal in FY2023 at 1.64%.

Growth, interest income and shareholder returns

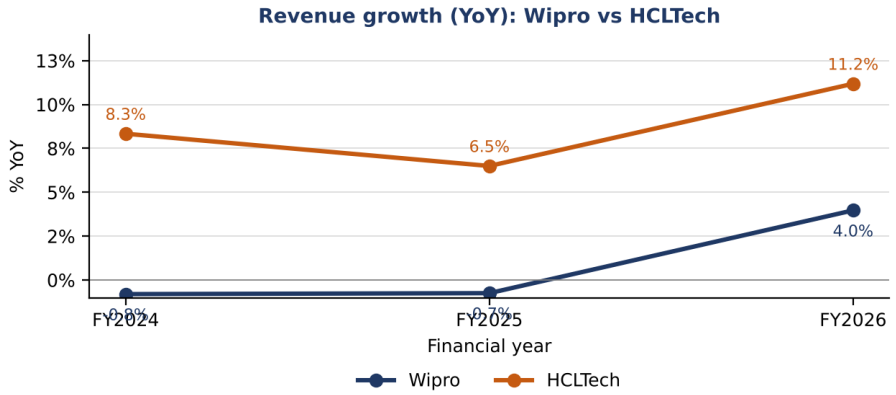


Figure 11 – Revenue growth (year on year). HCLTech grew in every year; Wipro was flat to slightly negative until FY2026.

Which company experienced stronger revenue growth, and did it support the investment strategy? HCLTech: revenue grew 6% to 11% a year while CapEx stayed near 1% of revenue, which implies a capital-light model that scaled efficiently. At Wipro, CapEx per rupee of revenue held up while revenue stagnated, so the spending has not yet translated into growth. That is consistent with investing for a future recovery, but four years of data cannot prove the spending was productive.

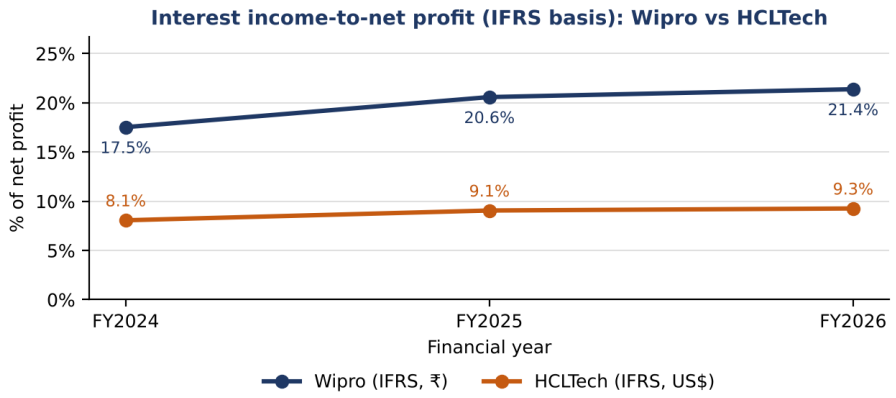


Figure 12 – Interest income-to-net profit on an IFRS basis, FY2024 to FY2026. Wipro in ₹; HCLTech in US$. FY2023 is not available for HCLTech.

Which company generated more interest income? On the ratio that can be compared, Wipro: interest income was 21.4% of its FY2026 profit against 9.3% at HCLTech. An absolute ₹ comparison is not made, because HCLTech's ₹ note-level interest income is not available and converting its US$ figures would require an estimate. Wipro earns interest on a gross-cash base 1.65 times HCLTech's.

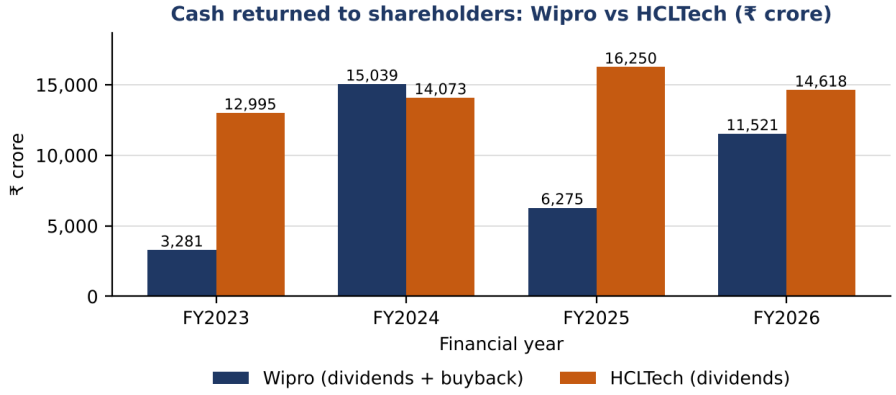


Figure 13 – Cash returned to shareholders, ₹ crore. Wipro: dividends and buyback. HCLTech: dividends.

Which company returned more capital to shareholders, and did higher liquidity come at the expense of investment? HCLTech returned more in total (₹57,936 crore against ₹36,116 crore over FY2023 to FY2026), and with a steadier payout of 88% to 93% a year. Wipro's payout was 29%, 135%, 47% and 87%. Higher liquidity did not come at the expense of investment: Wipro holds more liquidity and also spends a higher share of revenue on CapEx. The visible trade-off is in distributions, where Wipro paid out less.

10. Cash Preservation vs Capital Expenditure Evaluation

To avoid assuming the answer in advance, each company is scored against a fixed set of tests taken from the data. "Yes" means the data supports the statement over FY2023 to FY2026.

Table 8 – Evidence scorecard

Test (data-based)	Wipro	HCLTech
Higher cash + liquid investments as % of assets in FY2026	Yes (38.9%)	No (28.8%)
Treasury grew in rupee terms FY2023–FY2026	Yes (+37.6%)	Yes (+44.9%)
Bank cash and equivalents grew FY2023–FY2026	Yes (+14.9%)	No (−8.8%)

Test (data-based)	Wipro	HCLTech
Higher CapEx-to-revenue in FY2026	Yes (1.68%)	No (1.09%)
FY2026 CapEx above FY2023 CapEx	Yes (+5.2%)	No (−14.4%)
CapEx rebuilt after the FY2024 dip	Yes (+48.5%)	Yes (+35.7%)
Revenue grew faster than 5% a year (CAGR)	No (0.8%)	Yes (8.7%)
Cumulative cash returned above 85% of cumulative profit	No (73.8%)	Yes (89.7%)
Interest income above 15% of FY2026 net profit	Yes (21.4%)	No (9.3%, IFRS)

The scorecard shows that the two firms are not opposites. Both preserve cash through large, growing treasuries, and both spend little on CapEx relative to revenue. Wipro leans a little more to preservation on the balance sheet (a bigger treasury share) and a little more to reinvestment per rupee of sales, but with weak growth. HCLTech leans more to returning cash and to growing revenue. A simple label of "cash preserver" for one and "expander" for the other is not supported by the data.

The most useful distinction is in how surplus is used. HCLTech distributes most of its profit as dividends and still grows its treasury. Wipro keeps more funds invested, earns more from them, and returns cash in larger, less regular steps such as buybacks and the FY2026 dividend.

11. Impact of Interest Rates and Industry Conditions

Interest rates

The Reserve Bank of India kept its repo rate at 6.50% from February 2023 until February 2025, then cut it during 2025 to 5.25% by December 2025 (the path before October 2026 comes from secondary compilations; the RBI website should be used to confirm). The RBI's monetary policy resolutions show that the rate was held at 5.25% at the August 2026 review and then raised by 25 basis points to 5.50% on 7 October 2026, with the stance changed to calibrated tightening. That hike falls after the study period and is not reflected in the FY2026 figures.

This matters for treasury income. In FY2023 to FY2025, when rates were high and treasuries were growing, Wipro's interest income rose from ₹1,689 crore to ₹2,721 crore, and cash interest received rose 86%, from ₹1,411 crore to ₹2,621 crore. Interest as a share of average gross cash was 4.8% in FY2024, 5.7% in FY2025 and 5.2% in FY2026 at Wipro, and 5.3% in FY2025 and 4.9% in FY2026 at HCLTech (IFRS, US$). These yields are accounting proxies that mix ₹ and US$ assets. Coverage of Wipro's earnings call cites a 7.3% accounting yield on its India-held investments, a secondary source that has not been checked against the filings.

The yield dipped at both companies in FY2026 as policy rates fell, which raises the opportunity cost of idle cash. For comparison, HCLTech reports a company-level return on invested capital of 40.3%, though that measure is defined differently and is not directly comparable. The dip is an interpretation, but a reasonable one: lower yields on reinvested funds reduce treasury income unless balances grow faster, and the October 2026 hike partly reverses the pressure.

Industry demand and AI

Demand for IT services was soft in the period. Wipro's FY2026 IT services revenue fell 1.6% in constant currency and it guided to −2% to 0% sequential growth for Q1 FY2027. HCLTech grew 3.9% in constant currency in FY2026 but guided only 1% to 4% for FY2027, citing lower discretionary spending and delayed client decisions. Both companies describe AI as the main new growth area. HCLTech's annualised Advanced AI revenue passed US$620 million in Q4 FY2026, and Wipro has set up an AI Native Business & Platforms unit.

In weak demand, holding surplus liquidity is rational because it provides insurance and strategic options. The risk is that surplus funds earn less than the business could earn if redeployed. The AI shift raises the stakes. If AI services need heavier infrastructure (HCLTech's announced data-centre plans are one example), CapEx may rise from the very low levels seen in FY2023 to FY2026. The balance sheets of both companies can fund such a step.

Acquisitions and shareholder returns

Acquisitions were a more important use of growth capital than CapEx in several years. Wipro spent ₹4,557 crore (FY2023), ₹529 crore, ₹96 crore and ₹2,603 crore (FY2026, including Harman DTS); HCLTech spent ₹738 crore, ₹2,048 crore, ₹2,032 crore and ₹160 crore. On shareholder returns, Wipro completed a ₹12,000 crore buyback in FY2024 (cash outflow ₹14,517 crore including tax) and its Board approved a ₹15,000 crore buyback in April 2026, equal to about 27% of Wipro's FY2026 gross cash. HCLTech paid ₹57,936 crore in dividends over four years.

12. Strategic Evaluation

This section separates reported facts from interpretation. Facts come from the filings. Interpretation is the authors' judgement and is labelled as such. The classification of each company is drawn from the evidence above and was not assumed in advance.

Wipro

Reported facts: gross cash grew from 34.1% to 38.9% of assets; CapEx dipped then recovered to above the FY2023 level; interest income rose 68%; revenue was nearly flat; a ₹12,000 crore buyback was completed in FY2024 and a ₹15,000 crore buyback was announced in April 2026; borrowings are ₹16,787 crore; dividends of ₹11,521 crore were paid in FY2026.

Interpretation: Wipro follows a **mixed capital allocation strategy with a liquidity-heavy balance sheet**. It has the highest liquidity ratio and its reserves grew 37.6%, which points to cash preservation. But its cash flows tell a different story: distributions are lumpy (a large FY2024 buyback and a large FY2026 dividend), acquisitions are episodic, and CapEx intensity is above HCLTech's. Confidence is moderate. The label would move towards cash preservation if the announced buyback lapsed and reserves kept rising, and towards a balanced strategy if payouts stabilised near 85% to 90%.

HCL Technologies

Reported facts: gross cash grew from 24.7% to 28.8% of assets and net cash reached ₹33,288 crore; CapEx dipped to ₹1,048 crore in FY2024 then rose to ₹1,422 crore; revenue grew every year; dividends of ₹57,936 crore were paid over four years, 87% to 93% of profit each year; company ROIC was 40.3% in FY2026; AI data-centre investments were announced after year-end.

Interpretation: HCLTech follows a **balanced treasury strategy weighted towards distributions**. It keeps a sizeable treasury and almost no debt, distributes most of its profit, and grows through services and software rather than fixed assets. It is neither a cash hoarder nor an investment-led expander. Its strategy shifted modestly in FY2026, when CapEx rose 28% and acquisition spending fell, and the announced AI data-centre plans may mark the start of a more capital-intensive phase. Evidence for that is thin because the spending is not yet in the numbers. Confidence is moderate. The label would move to investment-oriented if CapEx and acquisitions rose well above about 2% of revenue.

Why might each company have chosen this approach?

These are possible explanations drawn from the data, not statements of management intent. Wipro's flat revenue, 112.6% cash conversion and pending acquisitions and buyback favour a large liquidity buffer,

and low-coupon debt alongside cash earning about 5% gives positive carry. HCLTech's asset-light model and free cash flow of 107% of net income let it fund dividends and selective acquisitions while still growing reserves. High rates in FY2023 to FY2025 made holding cash profitable (about one-fifth of Wipro's profit); lower rates raise the cost of idle cash and support distributions and acquisitions. AI may be funded more through acquisitions, partnerships and talent than buildings, but data-centre commitments show a route to higher CapEx. The cost of liquidity is that yields of about 5% sit well below operating returns, and securities carry credit and market risk.

Did either company change strategy?

Not fundamentally. Both reduced CapEx in FY2024 and increased it afterwards, and gross cash rose in every year at both. A falling CapEx-to-revenue ratio at HCLTech should not be read as investment being frozen, because its CapEx has risen since FY2024 and its revenue grew 28%. At Wipro the change is in how cash was used: a build-up in FY2025 (gross cash +32.6%) followed by deployment in FY2026 through dividends of ₹11,521 crore, acquisitions of ₹2,603 crore and a new buyback. HCLTech moved from acquisition-heavy FY2024–25 to higher CapEx and lower acquisition spending in FY2026.

What the evidence cannot show

The study can show outcomes, not management intent. It cannot say whether the CapEx level was optimal. HCLTech's ₹ interest income and its FY2023 interest income were not available, and two HCLTech items (FY2025 other income and FY2023–24 net profit basis) are flagged for further verification. Statements about AI plans and acquisitions rely on company releases and are announced intentions.

13. Key Findings

1. The original workbook contained material errors: of 48 data points compared, 27 needed correction, including HCLTech's other income (figures from another entity or year) and HCLTech's "cash", which included bank deposits.
2. Both companies hold large and growing liquid treasuries: 38.9% of assets at Wipro and 28.8% at HCLTech in FY2026 on a comparable gross-cash basis.
3. On pure bank cash the two are close in FY2026 (7.4% against 7.1%). HCLTech's ratio fell because it keeps surplus in deposits and investments.
4. CapEx is small at both firms (about 1% to 1.7% of revenue). Both cut CapEx in FY2024 and rebuilt it by FY2026. Neither froze investment.
5. Wipro invested a higher share of revenue than HCLTech in FY2024 to FY2026, but its revenue was flat until FY2026.
6. HCLTech's revenue grew 8.7% a year against Wipro's 0.8%, with a lower level of CapEx intensity.
7. Interest income is 21.4% of Wipro's net profit against 9.3% at HCLTech (IFRS). Wipro's earnings are more exposed to falling rates. Total other income equals 27.5% of Wipro's net profit and 9.2% of HCLTech's, but it contains non-interest items.
8. Shareholder returns: HCLTech returned 89.7% of cumulative profit, almost all as dividends. Wipro returned 73.8%, in larger and less regular steps.
9. Neither company fits the simple split of "cash preserver" against "expander". Wipro is a mixed capital allocation strategy; HCLTech is a balanced strategy weighted towards distributions.

14. Conclusion

The title of this study asks whether Wipro and HCLTech differ in preserving cash versus spending on CapEx. The answer from the data is that they differ less than commonly assumed. Both are capital-light, cash-generating businesses that keep substantial treasuries, spend about 1% to 2% of revenue on CapEx, and return a large share of profit to shareholders. The more meaningful differences lie in growth, in how much each company relies on treasury income, and in how surplus funds are distributed.

Wipro carried a larger treasury relative to assets and earned more from it, but its revenue barely grew in three years and about one-fifth of its profit was interest income. HCLTech grew faster, paid out nearly 90% of its profit and kept a strong net cash position, but its profit fell in FY2026 and its CapEx is still below the FY2023 level. Neither company shows reckless spending or excessive hoarding.

These conclusions hold within the limits listed in Section 16, in particular the unavailable HCLTech ₹ interest-income note and the different accounting bases (IFRS for Wipro, Ind AS for HCLTech).

15. Recommendations

The five questions below are answered using liquidity, profitability, growth, investment efficiency and shareholder returns together, not cash or CapEx alone.

1. Which company followed the more conservative treasury strategy? Wipro on the balance sheet: its treasury is a larger share of assets (38.9% against 28.8%), its bank cash grew while HCLTech's fell, and it earns more from surplus funds. On cash flows it is less conservative, with lumpy distributions and acquisitions, and it carries about ₹16,800 crore of borrowings.

2. Which company demonstrated stronger capital investment? By intensity, Wipro (1.68% against 1.09% of revenue in FY2026, and CapEx above its FY2023 level). By momentum and announced plans, HCLTech (CapEx +28% in FY2026 and the data-centre announcements). The data support only a narrow edge for Wipro on realised spending.

3. Which company used its financial resources more effectively? HCLTech, modestly. It produced 8.7% annual revenue growth against 0.8%, a 40.3% company ROIC, free cash flow of 107% of net income and ₹33,288 crore of net cash, with lower CapEx intensity. Wipro converted 112.6% of net income to operating cash flow in FY2026, which is also strong, but its growth did not match.

4. Which company appears better positioned for long-term growth? HCLTech, with less certainty. Faster growth, a broader mix (services plus software) and early AI revenue support this view. Wipro has more financial firepower and a clear AI strategy, so a change in execution could narrow the gap. HCLTech's own FY2027 guidance (1% to 4%) shows that growth is slowing.

5. Which company made the smarter financial decisions for shareholders? HCLTech has the stronger record on the available evidence: higher growth, high and steady dividends and no weakening of balance-sheet strength. Wipro's buyback and FY2026 dividend returned meaningful cash but came alongside weak growth. The margin is not large, and a reader who weights balance-sheet flexibility more heavily could reasonably prefer Wipro.

Recommendations for treasury policy

- **Wipro:** set an explicit target range for surplus liquidity and tie any excess to buybacks or growth investments, so that high balances do not dilute returns. Plan for lower treasury income as yields fall, since interest is about one-fifth of profit.

- **HCLTech:** keep the payout discipline but publish a clear framework for AI-related CapEx and its expected returns. Explain the FY2025 other-income spike. Consider disclosing interest income in ₹ in one clearly labelled note.
- **Both:** report CapEx on one defined basis (PP&E plus intangibles) and show cash and treasury investments separately, so that analysts can compare them without adjustment.

This report is an independent analysis of public data and is not investment advice.

16. Limitations of the Study

- HCLTech's ₹ note-level interest income is not available. HCLTech's interest figures come from its IFRS statements in US dollars (FY2024 to FY2026) and are not converted to ₹; FY2023 is not available. Other income, which contains non-interest items, is used where interest is missing.
- Wipro reports under IFRS and HCLTech under Ind AS. The differences were not reconciled. Both are consolidated and share the 31 March year-end. The interest ratio compares two IFRS ratios.
- CapEx definitions differ. HCLTech's cash-flow line combines PP&E and intangibles; Wipro's shows PP&E only. Neither includes acquisitions or leases.
- Liquid-asset definitions are close but not identical. HCLTech's gross cash is the company's own measure; Wipro's comparable measure adds non-current deposits to cash and current investments and excludes non-current equity stakes and fixed-maturity funds. Small differences should not be over-interpreted.
- Two HCLTech items remain flagged "Requires further verification" in the workbook: FY2025 other income (corroborated by arithmetic but not read in a primary ₹ source) and FY2023–24 net profit (the owners-only and total-profit figures differ slightly; the statutory total is used). HCLTech's IFRS statements and investor release carry no page numbers in the extracted text, so statements and notes are named instead.
- Wipro's FY2026 figures are taken from the audited Q4 FY2026 consolidated statements and were not re-tied line by line to the Form 20-F.
- The FY2025 jump in HCLTech's other income was linked to a divestment gain in its IFRS statements but not analysed in the Ind AS notes. The April 2026 Wipro buyback was subject to shareholder approval and its completion was not verified. HCLTech's data-centre plans are announcements made after FY2026; their timing and spend are not in the data.
- The RBI policy path before October 2026 comes from secondary compilations. Wipro's 7.3% investment yield comes from earnings-call coverage and was not checked against the filings.
- Four years is a short period. Results reflect a cycle of high rates, weak IT demand and the start of the AI shift, and may not generalise.

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Source tags in square brackets match the "Sources & References" sheet of the companion workbook, which also gives page and note numbers for every figure.

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